

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1991-04-03

To all National Spiritual Assemblies

1 dear b ahá'í f riends,

further to the riḫv́án 1991 message which has already been mailed to

2 lowing advice and information with regard to the forthcoming h oly y ear.

3 you are already aware of the two major events of the year: the commemo-

4 rative gathering in the holy land during may 1992 to mark the 100th an-

5 niversary of the Ascension of bahá'u'lláh, and the world congress in New

6 york during November 1992 to celebrate the centenary of the inauguration

7 of his covenant. As the time draws closer, you will be receiving more and

8 more communications from the various agencies acting on behalf of the house of
justice in making preparations for these events. To prevent confu-

9 sion and to enable you to respond effectively to these communications, the

10 house of justice suggests that, if you have not already done so, you appoint

11 an active, efficient and reliable individual or small committee to study these

communications on your behalf, keep you thoroughly informed of their

12 contents and requirements, and assist you to coordinate your responses and

13 to take timely and necessary actions in relation to your community.

14 As was pointed out in the riḫv́án 1990 message,

15 107-2 the two major events

16 being planned should not be the only commemorative activities of the holy

17 107-1. See no. 109, pp. 203–5.

18 107-2. See no. 91, p. 168.106.1

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108 1986–1992 • T h e S i x Y e a r P l a n

109 195year; indeed, the entire bahá'í world at its local and national levels will
110 engage in activities appropriate to the purposes of the holy year. it is impor-
111 tant that throughout this period the attitude of the friends in all localities
112 reflects the significance of the two occasions to be commemorated.
113 for the observance of the first occasion, the centenary of bahá'u'lláh's
114 passing, you will want to make sure that a proper devotional program takes
115 place in each locality, at the appropriate time on 29 may, and that the best
116 effort is made to uphold the preeminent importance, the dignity and the
117 profoundly spiritual character of the occasion, to which non-b ahá'ís may be
118 invited according to the discretion of the Spiritual Assemblies. To support
119 your preparations and to unite the hearts and experience of the believers
120 worldwide, the house of justice will soon be sending to you the sacred
121 readings which have been selected for the gathering at the most holy Shrine
122 on that occasion. beyond these devotional programs, the friends may plan
123 to hold other special events—national, regional or local—for the benefit of both
themselves and non-b ahá'ís, to give a more public character to the
124 observance of this anniversary and at which informative and inspirational
125 presentations on the life and teachings of bahá'u'lláh can be made and dis-
126 cussions held.

for the second commemoration, communities everywhere, at local, re-

127 gional and national levels, should plan to hold events in relation to the world
congress. Some of these may be held at the same time as the world
128 congress, some at other times. whatever the decision of the Spiritual As-
129 semblies, the events should have the same objective as the world congress,
130 which is to celebrate the centenary of the inauguration of the covenant of
131 bahá'u'lláh and to proclaim its aims and unifying power. The prospect of
132 such events should encourage the friends to study the history and meaning
133 of the covenant; in such study, the continental counselors, the Auxiliary
134 board members and their assistants will, no doubt, be sources of encourage-ment,
stimulation and assistance.
135 celebration in this connection does not mean merely festive activities.
136 it is primarily a spiritual celebration that is called for: occasions for deep

137 reflection on the historic importance, the uniqueness, the meaning and the efficacy of
the covenant established by bahá'u'lláh, on the outstanding
138 results of its influence in raising up a worldwide community comprising a
139 great diversity of members, and on the triumph of its virtue as a unifying
140 power. At the heart of such reflection will be contemplation of the peer-less purpose,
magnetic person, luminous character and exemplary acts of 107 .4

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108 m e S a g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e

109 196' Abdu'l-b ahá in his station as the center and living embodiment of the
110 covenant of bahá'u'lláh. consciousness of the exceptional and glorious
111 stage in humanity's spiritual evolution initiated by the covenant, the awe
112 such consciousness inspires and the thankful gladness it induces are of the
113 essence of the celebration intended by the world congress and all other
114 events associated with this centenary. A major purpose of these events will
115 therefore be to evoke this solemn consciousness, which is itself the well-
116 spring of the most exquisite celebratory joy. in this spirit the commemora-
117 tive activities around the world should acclaim and proclaim the covenant
118 as the pivotal center of unity for all humankind and illustrate its dynamic
119 effect on the struggle, the spread, and the redemptive achievements of the
120 bahá'í community since the passing of the b lessed b eauty.

you will undoubtedly appreciate that publicity through the mass media

121 should be incorporated into your plans for the holy year. All suitable and
122 available creative resources—writers, artists, composers, musicians, poets, public
information experts—should be called to the aid of the community, so as to imbue its plans
with the most effective and attractive variety of
123 expression. The world center will be interested in learning of these plans
124 as they are developed, so that news of them might be shared with others.
125 An important feature of the activities of the holy year will be the widest
126 possible proclamation of the Name of bahá'u'lláh; care must, of course,
127 be exercised in all situations to uphold the dignity of this Name. As an as-
128 sistance to your efforts, a statement on bahá'u'lláh has been prepared, at the

request of the house of justice, by the office of public information at the
 bahá'í world center. we are happy to enclose a copy.
 bearing the title Bahá'u'lláh, the statement is intended primarily for wide
 distribution to the public; however, as you will readily see, it has great value as a
 source of study and inspiration for the friends themselves. you are free
 to translate and print it in dignified but moderately priced editions so that its cost to
 the friends will be affordable. perhaps you will want to collaborate
 with other National Assemblies or with the publishing trust of any one of them in
 acquiring a supply of the printed material for your community. you
 may also wish to produce a special edition for presentation to dignitaries and
 prominent figures in your country; the office of public information is
 planning to print a special edition in english for limited use and you may
 find such an edition appropriate to your needs. furthermore, you will want
 to draw upon the statement in providing substance for various presentations on the
 faith to be made during the course of the holy year. it is left entirely 107 .7

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108 1986-1992 • The Six Year Plan

109 197to your discretion to determine in what ways you can most effectively ex-
 110 ploit its contents. whatever your plans, the house of justice expects that
 111 the statement will be published widely and abundantly for liberal distribu-tion and
 use by the friends everywhere.

112 107-3 National and local Spiritual

113 Assemblies and their agencies, with the encouragement and support of the
 114 continental counselors and their auxiliaries, will certainly see to the suc-
 115 cessful pursuit of these important objectives.

we have been asked to assure you of the ardent prayers of the house

116 of justice at the holy Shrines that your endeavors to raise ever higher the
 117 standard of bahá'u'lláh during the special year ahead may evoke his good
 118 pleasure and constant confirmations.
 119 with loving bahá'í greetings,

Department of the secretariat

120 108

Riḍván Message 1991

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]